

Internet

There's so much to find and do on the Internet but there are a few things that most people use. There is software for these tasks that one can freely download and use. They're made mostly to get data and information to you so you don't have to go to the sites.

7.1 Using a feed reader

You must have heard about RSS feeds which are basically tidbits of news that link to the main story. Now, there are millions of sites with updates every few days and some which update every few minutes. Keeping track of all this data is close to impossible. Feed readers come into the scene here.

Feed readers access RSS feeds and download the headlines to you. Plenty of sites have supported now and many are joining the bandwagon. Browsers immediately show sites with feed support with a visible RSS feed icon the location bar.

While there are plenty of feed readers to choose from, Feed Reader 3 is the application we'll be using for accessing feeds. You can select any feed reader of your choice. Feed Reader is small, light and simple to use. For all practical purposes, it works really well. The latest version of Feed Reader can be downloaded from its site – www.feedreader.com. Download and install the standard version of the application.

Adding interesting feeds through Feed Reader's database

Towards the end of the Feed Reader installation, Feed Reader prompts you for the feeds that you wish to add. A collection of feeds is displayed from Feed Reader's own database which you can select. If you missed the window, then you can add these same feeds by clicking on Tools > Preload Feeds.

Here, feeds can be chosen from a list of categories. The categories – Feedreader International Collection and Top 100 feeds might be of the most interest to you. A list of sub categories will be listed. Check the boxes for the feeds or categories you want in your list. Click OK when done.